

Making of the Constitution

Polity | Quick Revision Notes for rapid recall

Adopted: 26 Nov 1949	In force: 26 Jan 1950	Key body: Constituent Assembly
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1. Background

- The Constitution was framed by the Constituent Assembly, set up under the Cabinet Mission Plan, 1946.
- It was an indirectly elected body, chosen through provincial assemblies using proportional representation by single transferable vote.
- The Assembly worked through debates, committees, and compromise rather than a single-author draft.
- It first met on 9 Dec 1946 and later functioned as the legislature of independent India until 1952.

2. Key Numbers

Initial strength	389 members
After Partition	299 members
First President	Dr. Rajendra Prasad
Drafting Committee	Chaired by B. R. Ambedkar

3. Timeline You Must Remember

Date	Event
9 Dec 1946	First meeting of the Constituent Assembly.
11 Dec 1946	Dr. Rajendra Prasad elected President.
13 Dec 1946	Objectives Resolution moved by Jawaharlal Nehru.
22 Jan 1947	Objectives Resolution adopted.
29 Aug 1947	Drafting Committee appointed.
26 Nov 1949	Constitution adopted.
26 Jan 1950	Constitution came into force.

4. Committees and Objectives Resolution

- Drafting Committee - chaired by B. R. Ambedkar; responsible for turning principles into legal text.
- Union Powers Committee and Union Constitution Committee - chaired by Jawaharlal Nehru.
- Provincial Constitution Committee and Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights, Minorities, etc. - chaired by Sardar Patel.
- The Objectives Resolution, moved on 13 Dec 1946 and adopted on 22 Jan 1947, became the philosophical base of the Constitution and later shaped the Preamble.

5. Why It Matters

- The Constitution was built through consensus, debate, and committee scrutiny.
- It borrowed from several systems but was adapted to Indian conditions, making it both practical and ambitious.
- The Assembly worked during Partition and political uncertainty, yet still produced a durable constitutional framework.

6. Prelims Traps

- The first meeting was on 9 Dec 1946, not 26 Jan 1947.
- The Constitution was adopted on 26 Nov 1949, but it came into force on 26 Jan 1950.
- The Assembly was indirectly elected, not chosen by universal adult franchise.
- Dr. Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee, but he was not the sole author of the Constitution.

One-line revision: The Indian Constitution was drafted by the Constituent Assembly under the Cabinet Mission framework, shaped by the Objectives Resolution, refined through committees, adopted on 26 Nov 1949, and enforced on 26 Jan 1950.

7. Fast Recall

First sitting	9 Dec 1946
Objectives Resolution	13 Dec 1946 -> 22 Jan 1947
Drafting Committee	29 Aug 1947
Adopted / In force	26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950